U.S. Department of Labor

Occupational Safety and Health Administration
Jacksonville Area Office
1851 Executive Center Drive
Suite 227
Jacksonville, FL 32207
Telephone: (904) 232-2895 Facsimile: (904) 232-1294
www.osha.gov

February 27, 2016

Terry Chapman
77 Bridle Gate Drive
Crawfordville, FL 32327

RE: OSHA Complaint No. 1147043

Dear Mr. Chapman:

In Response to your complaint concerning safety/health hazards at U.S. Postal Service worksite located at 2800 S. Adams Street, Tallahassee, FL, the Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) conducted an inspection there. That inspection began on October 24, 2016.

The results of our investigation of your complaint items are as follows:

Complaint Item (1): Employees are exposed to ergonomic stressors of repetitive motion during sweeping and loading the Delivery Bar Code Sorters (DBCS's) for extended periods of time with only one employee.

> **FINDINGS:** The compliance officer conducted a physical inspection of the workplace. Employees and members of management were interviewed by the compliance officer regarding employees being exposed to ergonomic stressors. A violation of an OSHA standard was not substantiated at this time; an Ergonomic Hazard Alert Letter was issued to the employer.

If you do not agree with our inspection results, you may contact me for clarification of the matter. You also have the right to an informal review by the OSHA Regional Administrator, who may be contacted at the following location:

Kurt A. Petermeyer, Regional Administrator
Occupational Safety and Health Administration
Atlanta Federal Center
61 Forsyth Street, SW, Room 6T50
Atlanta, GA 30303
678-237-0400

This review may be obtained by submitting a written statement of your position with the Regional Administrator.

Section 17(g) of the OSH Act states that it is unlawful to make any false statement, representation or certification in any document filed pursuant to the Occupational Safety and Health Act of 1970. Violations can be punished by a fine of not more than $10,000, or by imprisonment of not more than six months, or by both.

Section 11(c) of the OSH Act provides protection for employees against discrimination because of their involvement in protected safety and health related activity. If you believe you are being treated differently or action is being taken against you because of your safety or health activity, you may file a complaint with OSHA. You should file this complaint as soon as possible, since OSHA can accept only those complaints filed within 30 days of the alleged discriminatory action.

Thank you for your interest in a safe and healthful work place.

Respectfully,

Brian Sturtecky
Area Director

Attachments

U.S. Department of Labor

Occupational Safety and Health Administration
1851 Executive Center Drive, Suite 227
Jacksonville, Florida 32207-2350
Telephone: 904-232-2895
Facsimile: 904-232-1294

Reply to the Attention of Area Director

February 27, 2017

U.S. Postal Service
Edward L. Miller, Postmaster
2800 S. Adams Street
Tallahassee, FL 32301

Re: Inspection No. 1186519

Dear Mr. Miller:

An inspection of your workplace at U.S. Postal Service (USPS) located at 2800 S. Adams Street Tallahassee, Florida, was conducted on October 24, 2016. We recognize that you are attempting to address injuries and illnesses resulting from manual material handling at the Delivery Bar Code Sorters (DBCS) operations at the Processing and Distribution Center and acknowledge your efforts. We noted concerns, however, regarding the following issues:

- Employees with apparent musculoskeletal disorders (MSDs) have visited their personal physicians and been treated by private doctors without obtaining a determination if their symptoms could be work related. We recommended you to provide training regarding early recognition of ergonomic hazards, lifting techniques, and stretching.

- During the Feeder task the employees are exposed to the hazard of developing musculoskeletal disorders (MSDs) while performing prolonged and repetitive tasks involving their hands and wrists. Ergonomic risk factors observed during the inspection related to hand and wrist injury are repeated forceful gripping, finger exertion and contact stress. Please refer to 2011 Ergonomic Hazard Alert Letter (EHAL) sent to the USPS to review recommended engineering, administrative, and work practice controls (attached document).

- During the Sweeper task the employees are exposed to the hazard of developing musculoskeletal disorders (MSDs) to the shoulder and back while performing repetitive, forceful tasks often while positioned in awkward postures for extended periods. Ergonomic risk factors identified during this operation include for the lower back and shoulder include repeated bending/reaching and repeated forceful pulling. Please refer to EHAL sent to the USPS to review recommended engineering, administrative, and work practice controls (attached document).

- The 2011 EHAL it was recommended "Schedule rotations between feeder and sweeper positions during DPS to ensure that the initial feeder on the first pass does not begin the second pass as the sweeper. This will prevent the same mail clerk from performing the most

physically demanding tasks" and that employee rotations occurring at least every 60 minutes. The recommended rotation schedule is not occurring at this facility.

In the interest of improving your current program, we recommend that you address the above concerns. You may voluntarily provide this Area Office with progress reports on your efforts to address these conditions. We may return to your place to further examine the conditions noted above.

Attached is a list of available resources that may be of assistance to you in preventing work-related injuries and illnesses in your workplace.

If you have any questions, please feel free to contact the Jacksonville Area Office at (904) 232-2895.

Sincerely,

Brian J. Sturtecky
Area Director